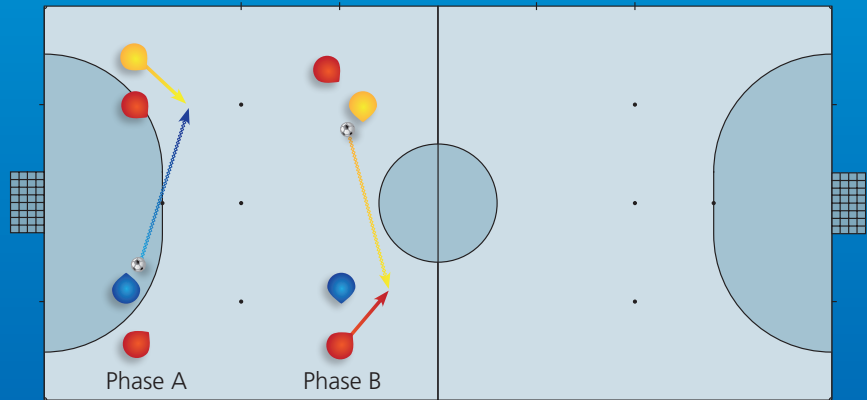


Drills for off-the-ball movement

15

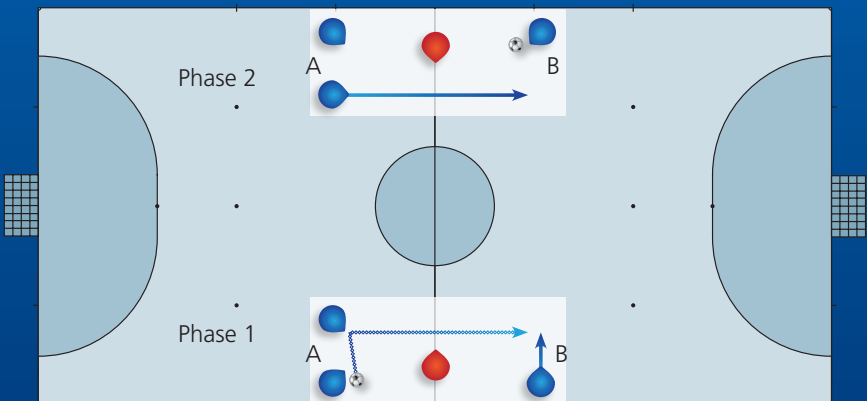


DRILL DESCRIPTION

Several groups of four players, each with a ball, spread out across the court. In each group, two players line up near one touch line and face the other two players in their group, positioned near the other touch line.

The player in yellow (Phase A) should make themselves available for a pass (in the 'open area') and receive the ball from their team-mate. The player in yellow then restarts the sequence (Phase B).

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DRILL DESCRIPTION

A 3v1 situation is arranged in a 4x8m rectangle. The two players in Zone A must get the ball to their team-mate in Zone B, who should make themselves available and receive the pass (Phase 1). One of the

two players in Zone A goes to join their team-mate in Zone B (Phase 2). Initially, the defender can move only along the line that divides the two zones. After that, they are free to move wherever they like.

1.4.3.8 Off-the-ball movement

Movement enabling a player to shake off an opponent and run into an ideal position ('open' area) to receive the ball from a team-mate. This aspect of individual tactics is a key factor in enabling the team with the ball to create opportunities. Off-the-ball movement is inextricably linked with the concept of mobility (movement), which is a cornerstone of group tactics when in possession of the ball. The player on the ball will not find it helpful if their team-mates remain static.

Off-the-ball movement

How? By making checked runs, runs involving a change in direction and pace, and runs diagonal to the goal line.

Where? In an area where players can receive the ball (an open area), i.e. the part of the court where the player on the ball can see a team-mate who has lost their marker.

When? At the right moment in the game.

Different ways to move off the ball

By dropping off in order to offer support, the forward moves towards the team-mate who has the ball, effectively shortening the distance between the passer and the recipient, while increasing the distance between themselves and the goal. Alternatively, the attacking player may choose to drop deeper than the player with the ball, thus creating a safe passing option. The attacker can also lose their marker by running free into space behind them. What this does is increase the distance between the player on the ball and the intended recipient of the pass, while also reducing the space between the latter and the opposition goal.

The 'open area' concept

This refers to the area in which the player in possession can see a team-mate who has thrown off their marker and is therefore able to deliver a pass to them. The size, shape and position of this space vary continually, depending on the position and actions of the defender marking the player

with the ball, as well as on the position of the other defenders and what they do.

The 'closed area' concept

This is the area of the court immediately behind a defender and into which the player in possession cannot pass the ball. The closer the defender is to the ball, the larger the 'closed off' area behind them. This area thus becomes a 'dead' zone for the team that has the ball.

Checked runs

These make it possible to get away from defenders into space and receive a pass more easily. The player heads in one direction before suddenly darting off the other way.

Running and changing direction

This is another way of gaining space on a direct opponent. It is very important to vary the speed of runs when changing direction.

For example: parallel, diagonal runs, etc.

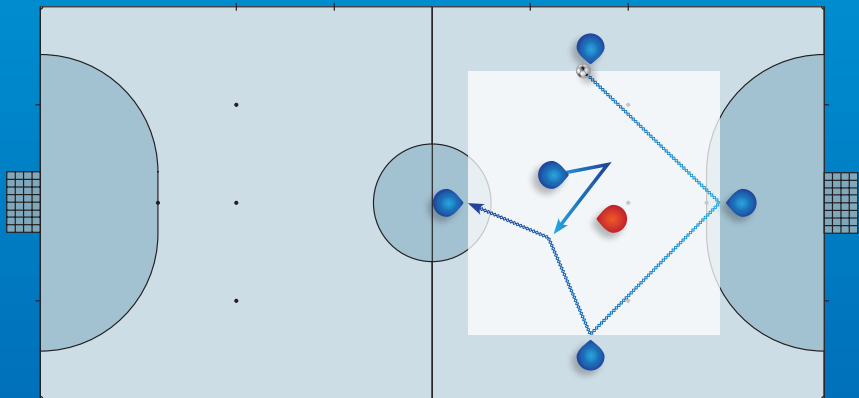
Getting behind the defender

This is a useful and effective way of losing a marker. It poses a problem for the defender, since they cannot concentrate on both the ball and the player they are marking.

Timing runs off the ball

Timing is extremely important when it comes to running off the ball. A player must run into space as soon as they see that the team-mate who has the ball is in a position to pass. Furthermore, it is important to assess the situation that the player who has the ball is in, in terms of the time and space available to them.

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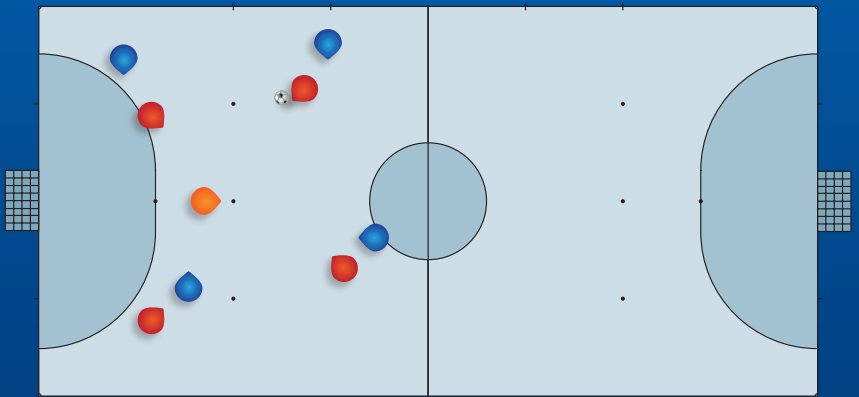


DRILL DESCRIPTION

Four players standing at the sides of a 12x14m rectangle pass the ball between themselves, taking two touches. A defender and an attacker are inside the rectangle. The attacker must try to find space by

checking their run, receive the ball from one of their four team-mates on the edge of the rectangle and then play the ball back to them.

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DRILL DESCRIPTION

Two teams of four to five players attempt to retain possession. Defenders should mark their direct opponent tightly. Within the playing area (half a court), one or two players

take the role of a joker, helping each team in turn to keep the ball. Players should be limited to two or three touches at a time.